

令和 8 年度 福知山公立大学 地域経営学部 一般選抜 前期日程 英語予想問題 3

問題 1 次の英文の要約を 200 字以内の日本語で書きなさい。

The number of vacant houses, known as "akiya," has reached a record high in Japan, posing a serious challenge to regional management. According to government data, more than 9 million homes now stand empty across the country. These abandoned structures are not just an eyesore; they represent a significant risk to public safety. They increase the danger of fire, attract criminal activity, and collapse easily during natural disasters, threatening the surrounding community.

For decades, Japan's tax system unintentionally encouraged owners to keep old houses standing. Under the fixed asset tax rules, land with a building on it received a massive tax break. Consequently, many owners chose to leave houses decaying rather than pay higher taxes on empty land. However, a major revision of the Vacant Houses Special Measures Act in 2023 changed this. The new law allows local governments to remove tax benefits for houses that are poorly maintained, forcing owners to either repair or remove them.

While stricter regulations are necessary, the ultimate goal should be the creative reuse of these properties. In various parts of Japan, innovative projects are turning abandoned houses into community assets. Some are being renovated into "satellite offices" for urban workers, while others serve as community cafes or affordable housing for young families. These initiatives transform "liabilities" into "resources," breathing new life into aging neighborhoods.

However, scaling these efforts requires a shift in local governance. Local authorities must act as matchmakers between owners and potential users. They need to simplify the complicated legal processes involving inherited property and provide subsidies for renovation. Furthermore, residents must rethink their relationship with land. In a shrinking society, we can no longer afford to view property solely as private wealth; instead, it must be managed as part of the shared regional landscape.

Ultimately, the akiya problem is not just about buildings, but about the future of the community itself. By effectively managing vacant land and structures, regions can improve their resilience and attractiveness. Success depends on the ability of local governments to foster a sense of collective responsibility among citizens to protect the value of their shared environment.

【語注】 vacant house : 空き家 eyesore : 目障りなもの、都市景観を損なうもの abandoned : 見捨てられた、放置された fixed asset tax : 固定資産税 decaying : 朽ちていく Special Measures Act : 特別措置法 liability : 負債、お荷物 initiative : 取り組み、構想 satellite office : サテライトオフィス（遠隔勤務用事務所） matchmaker : 仲介者、橋渡し役 resilience : 回復力、強靱さ

指導講師による解答のポイント（自己採点用）

以下の要素が含まれているか確認してください。

1. **現状:** 空き家増加が防災や防犯上のリスクとなり、地域の安全を脅かしている。
2. **制度の壁:** 従来の税制が放置を助長していたが、法改正により管理不全物件への厳罰化が進んだ。

3. **再生の視点:** 空き家を「負債」ではなく、オフィスやカフェ等の「資源」として活用する創造的再生が重要。
4. **結論:** 行政が仲介役となり、私有財産を地域の共有資産として管理する意識改革が必要である。